

Quillon Norwood

Character Dossier

Gentle and slow to trust gardener of the Emerald Court of Ardenne

Overview

Quillon Norwood is a gardener living in the Emerald Court of Ardenne. Quillon is 71 years old, originally from Marrow's End, and is known around the Mirror Gallery as gentle and slow to trust. In conversation Quillon mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Background

Quillon arrived in the Emerald Court of Ardenne 17 years ago after leaving Marrow's End under circumstances Quillon describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for House Ardenne; the second was the one that stuck. Today Quillon works as a gardener near the royal mews and is paid, when paid at all, in crowns.

Quillon learned the trade from Nkechi Irongate, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Quillon's life is with Delphine Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Quillon trusts most is Fitzgerald Achterberg.

Current goal: to map every path through the Mirror Gallery. Greatest fear: being forgotten.

Personality and speech

Temperament: gentle and slow to trust.

Speech pattern: Quillon mutters prices and measurements while thinking.

Tells: when lying, Quillon mentions Ollie the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Quillon Norwood
<i>Role</i>	gardener
<i>Home</i>	the Emerald Court of Ardenne
<i>Hometown</i>	Marrow's End
<i>Age</i>	71
<i>Favourite dish</i>	festival spiced pumpkin dumplings
<i>Pet</i>	Ollie, a beetle
<i>Lucky number</i>	141

<i>Workshop password</i>	cinder-granite
<i>Mentor</i>	Nkechi Irongate
<i>Rival</i>	Delphine Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Fitzgerald Achterberg

Secret

Quillon cannot actually read the old script everyone assumes they can, and has memorised the important pages.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Quillon: I am the gardener. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Quillon: Festival spiced pumpkin dumplings. Do not tell Delphine I said so.

Visitor: Is Ollie yours?

Quillon: Ollie belongs to nobody. Ollie tolerates me. Lucky number is 141, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 28

At the lower kitchens, Quillon taught Fitzgerald how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Quillon closed early, walked to the royal mews, and watched the lights come on. Ollie followed at a distance. Quillon closed early, walked to the royal mews, and watched the lights come on. Ollie followed at a distance.

Entry 2, winter of year 28

A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Quillon and Delphine outside the Sunken Garden; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Quillon found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Sunken Garden and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Quillon repaired the sextant at the Sunken Garden for Benedikt, who paid in 70 crowns and a long story about the right way to mend a net. The weather turned. Quillon moved the wax seal indoors, fed Ollie, and wrote three lines to Nkechi about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 3, summer of year 28

Quillon spent the day counting stock at the Sunken Garden: 36 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Quillon found a ledger half-buried near the Sunken Garden and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Quillon moved the hand bell indoors, fed Ollie, and wrote three lines to Nkechi about the new curfew. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Quillon and Delphine outside the Sunken Garden; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.